

BASIC INSTINCTS

Porn is becoming a popular stimulus for both partners with 34 per cent respondents admitting to having watched it with their spouses. But for the average Indian, the more basic, the better the porn is. What's more, both men and women seem to be on the same plane when it comes to the kinds of porn they watch.

31 Showing multiple men and one woman Male 36, Female 24	27 Showing only women Male 33, Female 17	83 Showing a man and a woman Male 84, Female 82	24 Showing multiple women and one man Male 32, Female 13	19 Showing only men Male 20, Female 16
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For 1,809 respondents of the total 5,371 who have watched porn with their partners. Figures add up to more than 100 because of multiple choices. All figures in per cent.

More men (19 per cent) than women (9 per cent) are uncomfortable watching porn with their partners.



Valentine's gifts of chocolates, roses, perfumes, silk lingerie and serenades is essentially based on this principle.

So the question that remains is: Is there an immoral aspect to pornography? Yes, there is and it is no different from any other aspect of life or social activity. It is when the inherent rights of individuals are abused. When the subjects of porn are forced into it and don't have the capacity to dissent or resist, as with trafficked women, children, and animals.

Talking of animals, it was interesting to note in the survey that men from Patna and Ludhiana showed some of the highest propensity for porn films involving animals. Ludhiana men also showed the highest interest in multiple male-single female porn films—51 per cent whereas the national average is 32 per cent. It makes one wonder if these sexual preferences in anyway reflect an underlying social issue. For these are also areas that have some of the lowest female to male sex ratio largely due to sex selected abortions and infanticide. It has been a practice for long in some of the

rural areas in this region for a household of brothers to 'share' a wife, due to the local unavailability of brides.

The issue of pornography is not so much a moral one as one of personal choice. Its tolerability is determined by individual preferences. Whichever of your senses does it for you is the one to go for and possibly visual stimulation might not be your cup of tea. Vatsyayana, India's oldest sexologist, had a sage piece of advice for couples. He said there are practices that are more acceptable for some people than for others depending on what family and community they are from. So couples will have to figure out between themselves, as to what they both like and dislike, are comfortable or uncomfortable with, and then engage in creative foreplay, respectful of each other's personal boundaries.

The writer is the author of Sex and Power: Defining History, Shaping Societies. She is also the founder of The 50 Million Missing: A Campaign Against India's Female Genocide.